Modal	Meaning	Example
can	to express ability	I can speak a little Russian.
can	to request permission	Can I open the window?
may	to express possibility	I may be home late.
may	to request permission	May I sit down, please?
must	to express obligation	I must go now.
must	to express strong belief	She must be over 90 years old.
should	to give advice	You should stop smoking.
would	to request or offer	Would you like a cup of tea?
would	in if-sentences	If I were you, I would say sorry.

Exercise

I. Use polite request when we seek help from others.

a) Fill in the blanks using **would you** or **could you**.

1. _____ please close the door?
2. _____ please open the window?
3. _____ mind going to the back bench?
4. _____ please bring some water for me?

b) Use the phrases **could you** or **would you** in the following situations with your friend.

1. Ask the policeman for directions.
2. You need to borrow your friend's bike.
3. You would need to exchange the book purchased.
4. You want to open your classroom window

Language Check Point

Correct	Incorrect	Explanation
I cannot say if he has passed the exam or not.	I cannot say whether he has passed the exam or not.	'Whether' is followed by 'or'
Hardly had she seen her aunt when she stopped fighting.	Hardly had she seen her aunt than she stopped fighting.	Hardly' is always followed by 'than'.

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